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# Understanding and Welcoming Your Emotions

*Your emotions aren't the enemy: they're messengers*

4 psychology approaches · by EvaTalk

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## TO BEGIN

# Your emotions aren't the enemy: they're messengers

We're often taught to fight our emotions — when they carry precious information (a need, a value, a danger). Fighting them amplifies them; welcoming them soothes them.

This guide helps you understand your emotions and welcome them, the first step of any regulation.

## YOUR INTENTION

An emotion that overwhelms you or that you struggle to welcome: \_\_\_\_\_

## Messengers, not enemies

Each emotion is a signal: fear warns of danger, anger defends a boundary, sadness signals a loss. There's sometimes a primary emotion (the real one) and a secondary one (the reaction to the first, e.g. anger about being sad).

Understanding that an emotion carries a message changes everything: you listen instead of fleeing.

### Example

*Léa fought her sadness; understanding it signaled a real lack let her listen to it.*

### The message

What might the emotion passing through you signal (need, value, alert)?

### A messenger

Write: 'My emotion carries a message; I listen to it.'

*Takeaway — Your emotions are messengers: they carry information, not a threat.*

## 'I shouldn't feel this'

'I shouldn't feel this', 'my emotions are dangerous', 'I'll lose control': these thoughts make you fight what you feel, which intensifies it.

Reframing them lets you feel without panicking.

### Example

*'Feeling anger is bad' guilted Sami, until he saw an emotion is neither good nor bad.*

### Spot the judgment

Note a thought judging your emotion · a fairer version.

### Neither good nor bad

Write: 'An emotion is neither good nor bad: it's information.'

*Takeaway — An emotion is neither good nor bad — judging it amplifies it.*

## All your emotions are legitimate

You have the right to feel what you feel, without judging yourself. Welcoming an emotion with compassion ('it's okay to feel this') isn't drowning in it: it's making room so it can pass.

What we welcome eases; what we fight insists.

### Example

*By allowing herself to feel without judging, Nia saw her emotions lose their intensity.*

### With compassion

How to welcome this emotion with gentleness rather than judgment?

### Make room

Write: 'I have the right to feel; I make room for my emotion.'

*Takeaway — All your emotions are legitimate — welcoming them soothes them.*

## Name, locate, listen to the need

In practice: name the emotion ('I feel anger'), locate it in your body (tight throat, knotted stomach), then ask what need it signals. Putting words on an emotion already lowers its intensity. Enriching your emotional vocabulary helps you regulate better.

We regulate better what we can name.

### Example

*By precisely naming his emotions, Karim gained clarity and calm, almost at once.*

### Name

Name a recent emotion, where you feel it, and the need behind it: \_\_\_\_\_

### Put words

Write: 'Naming my emotion already lowers its intensity.'

*Takeaway — Name, locate in your body, listen to the need: the basis of regulation.*

## Key takeaways

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- Your emotions are messengers: information, not a threat.
- Tell the primary emotion (the real one) from the secondary (the reaction).
- An emotion is neither good nor bad — judging it amplifies it.
- All your emotions are legitimate; welcoming them soothes them.
- Name the emotion and locate it in your body.
- Listen to the need it signals: we regulate better what we name.

## Your turn

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### My emotions

| The emotion's message | The judging thought |
|-----------------------|---------------------|
|                       |                     |
|                       |                     |
|                       |                     |
|                       |                     |

### Welcoming them

| Welcome with compassion | Name / the need |
|-------------------------|-----------------|
|                         |                 |
|                         |                 |
|                         |                 |
|                         |                 |



YOUR JOURNEY

## Your 4-week plan

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**Week 1**

See my emotions as messengers.

**Week 2**

Reframe 'I shouldn't feel this'.

**Week 3**

Welcome my emotions with compassion.

**Week 4**

Name, locate, listen to the need.

## YOUR PLAN

# Your action plan

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My 'my emotion carries a message' line:

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The need behind my emotion:

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How I welcome it:

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*Welcoming your emotions is already starting to soothe them.*

This guide is a coaching and psychoeducation tool, not therapy. If your emotions overwhelm you persistently or strongly affect your life, a professional (psychologist) can help. © PerfectMatch · EvaTalk.